



CYCLICK SAMPLES

email: cyclicksamples@gmail.com
twitter: twitter.com/cyclickbob

80s Synths Part One

Though the 1980s was the dawn of the digital audio age, analogue was not just tossed to the curb. Obviously the majority of recordings were going down to analogue tape via decidedly non-digital signal paths. Much of the digital audio flavour of the 80s came from the effects units used, from the high end Lexicon, AMS, Eventide and EMT units that had started to appear in the late 70s, to the less expensive but ubiquitous processors by Yamaha and Boss. With this in mind this sample collection has taken modelled versions of classic 80s synths (see below) and run them through an almost pure 1980s signal path. This starts with the Amek BCII mixing console for EQ, then on to a BSS DPR-402 compressor/limiter for some 4:1 ratio shaping/shaving and then into an SSL bus compressor clone for the final levelling. An aux line was run to two 80s effects, the Yamaha SPX1000 for modulations/short reverbs and the Boss DE-200 for 12-bit digital delay. These were folded back into the Amek BCII to get treated with the dry synth signal, as all effects within the synths were bypassed in favour of real 80s effects. The only plugins were the UAD ATR-102 through which the BCII stereo output was recorded to give it a little 80s tape flavour and the Ozone 8 Vintage Limiter (set to 'analog') to prevent any overshoots from the ATR-102 output.

Each bass synth instrument was tweaked into shape from raw templates and adjusted as the lines were played and edited in MIDI. Once the sound was settled upon, both in the synth and on the Amek/comps/FX end, the lines were recorded into loops and, with one exception, captured as multisamples, usually with the delay removed to stop tempo restrictive elements. The effects were changed when the instruments were used to record in a second tempo – there are four tempos and two sets of instruments, A and B.

The multisamples run from C1 to C4 (though technically some are actually C0 to C3) and, where necessary, have their sustain loop points embedded into the WAV file for easy transportation into samplers. A set of SFZ files are also included to save any manually key mapping. All multisamples are run with four even spaced notes per octave (C, D#, F# and A).

Outboard

Amek BCII mixer (BC1119/4 stereo channel)
BSS DPR-402 compressor/limiter
Gyraf GSSL bus compressor
Yamaha SPX1000 multi-effect processor
Boss DE-200 digital delay

Synths (from Arturia V Collection):

CZ V
DX7 V
CMI V
Jup-8 V3
Matrix-12 V2
Prophet V3
Synclavier V

Plugins:

UAD Ampex ATR-102 (post BCII)
Ozone 8 Vintage Limiter (post ATR-102 to prevent overshoots)